

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Linux
Mount point: In Unix-like operating systems, directories and devices are organised in the form of a directory tree. Each file is logically attached to the preceding file by a mount point, while the entire OS is mounted on /.
Grub: Acronym for GRand Unified Bootloader. Grub lets users choose OSes, in case of a multi-booted computer.
CLI: Command Line Interface is the original method of interacting with the OS, before point-click and drag-drop became ubiquitous. Users typed in various English-like words to perform actions like copying, creating and deleting directories and running programs.
Root: As root, you have ultimate administrative privileges in Linux. The root user can install software, delete system files, and if necessary, crash the OS with a few well chosen clicks or commands.
Shell scripts: Shell scripts are small snippets of code that can be typed in CLI, to perform simple and complicated system related tasks like searching and sorting, finding out patterns in data and so on. The scripts are written in a distinctive programming language.
Swap space: The swap space in Linux is used in a way similar to virtual memory on Windows.
Usage: I had insufficient swap space, so I logged in as root and used the CLI to type out a shell script and increased it. I also changed the default OS in Grub and changed the mount point of my external hard drive.

Wild Wild Web

Pointless Web

Zillions of new Web pages crop up and crowd the filled-to-the-brim beaker of the World Wide Web.

In case you were curious to skim the dregs of the Internet barrel, you'll find the most obnoxious sites at www.pointlessites.com. Just skim through the numerous pointless sites that are frequently featured here.

It lists only pointless and useless sites that don't have pop-up ads or too many ads in general. They are original, useless, are not offensive and most of all make you smile—family friendly fun! Well, we hope that you smile. The homepage rakes up the

newest pointless sites that pop up and allow you to be updated with all the latest crap happening around in the World Wide Web.

You are likely to waste more time here that ever... don't sue us for that though.

No More Monday Blues

You think you have a heavy workload? Try working 16 hour days, 7 days a week, in a poorly ventilated ambience? Hours of daily commute? Difficult co-workers? Poor pay? Well hold on, there must be an end to this. Alas, Your job isn't as bad as you think. Not completely crap; not yet! You always hear about people with jobs worse than

yours, but where are these people? At www.worst-jobs.com, that's where!

This site is meant to make you sigh with relief, after you find out that no matter how awful your boss is, at least he doesn't chop off your head when you do something wrong. Nor does he ask you to wade through the sewers, handle entrails and excreta, or stick your arm into the warm, cavernous bowels of large farm animals.

If your job is crappier, more dangerous or more poorly paid than the ones listed in there, let them know and you could win the Worst Jobs Trophy—which is given away at regular intervals.

before the Joshi Gakuen all-girls junior high school in Tokyo realised this.

Imagine this: a giggly gaggle of 32 seventh-graders merrily glued to their DS with the teacher applauding! The students are now on a fun-learning course with the novel idea of using the popularity of the handheld console to learn basic English lessons. The enthusiastic students gleefully engage themselves in spelling words like “hamburger” and “cola” on the touch panel screen of DS following an electronic voice from the machine. Judging from the popularity it seems the DS will make has made a breakthrough entry into classrooms.

Japanese education has long been infamous for failing to develop English conversation skills and instead focus on rote memorization and grammar. However, Yasuhiro Yamamoto, manager at software maker Paon Corp. believed that it is time to bring in some element of fun in to learning and came out with the DS English program.

With it, learning grammar and spelling had never been so much fun. When the students got the spelling right, the word “good” popped up on the screen, and the student went on to the next exercise. The first five students to complete the drills were awarded colourful stickers.

While the students have given an enthusiastic thumbs up to the new experiment Principal Tsuneo Saneyoshi revealed that the initiative is still in its trial stages and have received mixed response from the teachers. The school is getting 40 DS machines and free software for agreeing to be part of a test in a real classroom.

WIKI TRAP Research In Ignorance

What does the Internet generation do when they need to find something out? Like something for a research

project or an examination. Going to the libraries and reading through zillions of pages of voluminous text in black and white—naah that's for the ancients. For students and other folks in search of knowledge it's so very simple to find out what they want: Wikipedia. However they would be advised not to jump their guns immediately, because there is some disconcerting news. Wikipedia might make you fail the exams.

Boasting over two million articles, Wikipedia is used by about 6 per cent of internet users, significantly more than the traffic to more authorised sites. However, it isn't the most reliable one owing to the fact that it allows entries to be logged or updated by anyone and is not verified by researchers, as the main source of information.

The Scottish Parent Teacher Council (SPTC) has rather surprisingly blamed such Web sites for the falling passing rates in the state. (We believe those students need to get back to the 'Paathshala way'). Students rely on Web sites and other Internet resources that may

contain inaccurate or deliberately misleading information and there is no second thought (was there ever a first thought in place?) before implementing copy-paste and proposing it as their own work.

Eleanor Coner, the SPTC's information officer, acknowledges that Internet plagiarism is a problem. Pupils seem to believe that they won't be caught. However the Scottish Qualifications Authority has robust ways of checking for plagiarism and parents are worried their children will fail their exams.

Amassing information online is no-brain task now, but what is more important is to develop the skill of challenging what was presented as 'fact'. It is a skill that has to be learnt, and which many internet users won't have. Next time you thing of using Google or Wikipedia or for that matter any online resource, think of the authenticity before relying. Or better go back to libraries and surf the pages!

All Swell, That End Swell

A month of sickness again: Vijay's swollen belly was replaced with swollen feet; Rossi got swollen fingers from the *Fast Track*; Michael has a permanent swollen head; Nash had swollen eyes from issue closing; and our mailboxes were swollen with contest entries—too to count...

Uncle Chandiramani's university application finally came through, and he's off to *Amreeca* for further studies. At least there will be more food for us now, but one less person to frag in *Quake 3*. He promises to come back after his degree—providing he can come back as Raaabo's boss!

DIGIT DIARY

JOGGER POWER

Power Dancing

Imagine this—You are in the middle of a very important call, and your mobile battery is about to run out juice. Worse still, there is no charging socket around. Well, no need to pull your hair out anymore, just tap your toes and talk through. Thanks to a new gizmo, you now just need to face the music and dance. Quite a perfect way to charge up your device.

Mobile phone operator Orange said on Tuesday it had teamed up with GotWind, a firm specialising in renewable energy, to produce a recharger powered by movements alone. This is a good excuse for toe-tappers to dance their way through the streets to build up juice for their cellphones.

The device is very portable and can be just worn like an armband. It employs a weight and magnet to harness kinetic energy and covert it into an electric current to top up charge in a storage battery.

The product is fun, engaging and interactive that would encourage users to have a laugh while charging their mobile phone and at the same time test out a new energy-efficient prototype in these ecologically conscious times believes Hattie Magee, Head of Partnerships at Orange UK.

Now don't be surprised to have free dance shows on our streets, restaurants and almost anywhere!

In the meantime, researchers have now focussed their attention on the female breast motion. When a woman jogs, the three dimensional movement of her “assets” is thought to generate sufficient energy to power an iPod or a mobile phone. Though there are some issues like size and the quality of fabric covering the chest, the intrepid scientists believe that a solution will soon be available. We wait, with bated breath for this innovation that will lead the world nearer to eco friendliness. ☒

think diGit

Blog

WATCH

Featured here you will find snippets from some of the best bloggers who have registered at the Blog Watch section on thinkdigit.com. If you wish to be featured here, head to www.thinkdigit.com/blogger.php and sign-up.

akshayy
<http://tinyurl.com/6m793j>
<http://www.akshayy.com/sonyericsson/others/video-encoding/>

Video encoding
This is not really a flashing subject, though many people would like to know how to do it. So convert your SE phone to a media center where you can watch movies!! Or at least watch video clips.

The application I suggest using has the slogan “does for FREE what other encoders CAN'T do for money”. It's worth a try.

It is SUPER Simplified Universal Player Encoder & Renderer, the best you can find. A very nice application, with very frequent updates. That is the main reason why I'm not uploading it to the download site....go to this site: <http://www.erightssoft.net/SUPER.html>.Then Scroll down to the bottom where you can see this link “Start Downloading SUPER ©”.....

Sony Ericsson phones support 3GP and MP4 formats, camera records in 3GP. So choose 3gp (Sony Ericsson) as Output Container at the top.

According to my tests, Video Codec should be MPEG-4, and Audio Codec should be AAC. These are compatible with SE video player.

Binoy Xavier Joy
<http://tinyurl.com/5o9ppa>
<http://tec-talkz.blogspot.com/2008/07/google-adsense-referrals-retiring.html>

Google withdraws Adsense Referrals
Earlier today, Google launched an affiliate ad network. Or, rather, it rebranded Performics, the affiliate ad network that came along with its purchase of DoubleClick, as the “Google Affiliate Network.” As with other affiliate networks such as Amazon's, participating Website publishers get paid a fee for each referral that results in a sale. Existing advertisers include Bank of America, Barnes & Noble, Citi, Target, and Verizon.

Google is also insisting you to update your Adsense account to Google account as a compulsory step...